Retirement Plan

Annual administration in plain steps.

AGE 50 — *the year we retire*

- ☐ Stop working.
- ☐ Move both 401(k)s into Trad IRAs.
- ☐ Begin the yearly transfer from the Trad IRA into Roth IRA.
- ☐ Sign up for health insurance on the ACA marketplace.
- ☐ Live on taxable investment account.

AGES 51–54 — *bridge years*

- ☐ Make yearly Traditional → Roth transfers.
- ☐ Live on taxable investment account.

AGE 55 — *pension begins*

- ☐ File to start BP pension.
- ☐ Live on transferred Roth investment account.

AGES 56–59

- ☐ Live on each transferred Roth investment account.

AGES 60–61 — *401k begins*

- ☐ Draw from whichever accounts make the most sense.

AGE 62 — *Social Security begins*

- ☐ Both of us file for Social Security.

AGES 63–64

- ☐ Live on Social Security, the pension, and savings.

AGE 65 — *Medicare begins*

- ☐ Enroll in Medicare around birthdays. **Don't miss it.**
- ☐ Cancel the ACA health plan.
- ☐ Begin the yearly "cleanup" Trad → Roth transfer.

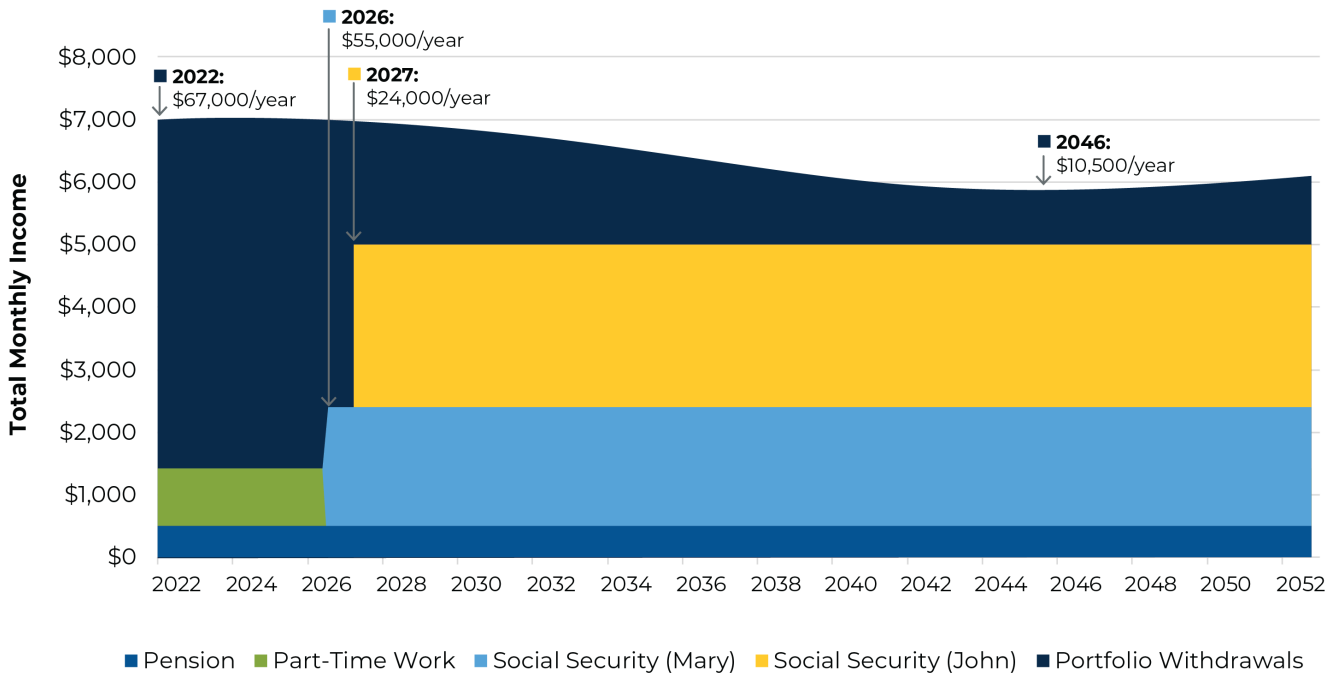
AGES 66–74

- ☐ Make yearly Trad → Roth transfer to lower future RMDs.
- ☐ Live on Social Security, the pension, and savings.

AGES 75–90

- ☐ Each year, take RMD from the Trad IRA.

The Retirement Distribution Hatchet



Source: Income Lab

Retirement Account Timeline

Which accounts to draw from, receive income from, or act on for ages 50 to 90.

